Xinyi Li

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Spatial Economics, Firm Dynamics, Development Economics

EDUCATION

University of Notre Dame — Notre Dame, IN
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2027 (exp.)
M.A. in Economics — 2023

Central University of Finance and Economics (CUFE) — Beijing, China
M.S. in Finance — 2020
B.S. in Economics — 2017

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Land-Use Policy as Industrial Policy: Firm Selection, Spatial Misallocation, and Rural-Urban Redistribution" 2026

Abstract: This paper studies how the preferential allocation of urban land to industrial use affects productivity, aggregate output and welfare through firm selection and rural-urban migration, using China's primary urban land market as an empirical setting. The data suggest that prefectures where industrial land is relatively cheaper allocate more land and employment to manufacturing and sustain more firms, yet have lower average productivity and only modestly higher manufacturing output. In particular, discounted industrial land sustains marginal low-productive firms and weakens selection, with rural migrants accounting for much of the higher manufacturing employment in these prefectures. The paper then develops a spatial equilibrium model with heterogeneous firms, rural-urban migration and land allocation to quantify the aggregate and distributional impacts of land price discount. Eliminating the within-prefecture land price discount reduces manufacturing output by 5.2% but raises average productivity by about 7%. These effects are driven primarily by improved firm selection. The welfare impacts are distributional: urban welfare increases by 2.3%, driven mainly by lower housing prices, whereas rural welfare falls by 0.6% as urban manufacturing labor demand contracts. Furthermore, the inefficiency lies primarily in where industrial land is allocated rather than in its aggregate share. These findings imply that evaluating place-based industrial policy requires considering not only output and employment, but also which firms produce, where production occurs, and who gains or loses.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Energy Transitions and Their Distributional Impacts: 2005 and 2050" with Danchen Zhao

"How Free is Free Entry" with Dario Cardamone and Benjamin Pugsley

"Ripple Effects of Government Procurement: Market Response across Pharmaceutical Markets" with Yiren Ding

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Heitor S. Pellegrina, University of Notre Dame — 2023–2025

Full-time Research Assistant to Prof. Yongmiao Hong, Xiamen University — 2020–2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Principles of Microeconomics, University of Notre Dame	Fall and Summer 2026
Teaching Assistant, Statistics for Economics, University of Notre Dame	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Econometrics II, University of Notre Dame	Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Macroeconomics I, University of Notre Dame	Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant, Principles of Economics, CUFE	Spring 2020 and Fall 2019

AFFILIATIONS

Building Inclusive Growth (BIG) Lab, University of Notre Dame	2024–present
Kellogg Institute for International Studies, University of Notre Dame	2023–present

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Franco Family Institute Dissertation Fellowship	2026-2027
Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grant	2025
BIG Lab Ph.D. Research Grant	2025
Kellogg Institute Professionalization Grant	2024

PRESENTATIONS

2026 Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC) (scheduled)
Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings (scheduled)

2025 Southern Economic Association (SEA)

SKILLS

Programming: MATLAB, Stata, ArcGIS, Julia, LaTeX

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

REFERENCES

Benjamin Pugsley (Chair)
Robert and Irene Bozzone Associate Professor
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